

that leads to this: there's also the fact that poor spelling or grammar distracts, so the viewers lose precious thinking time.

2.1.2.7 Structure and organisation

We left this for last because it's obvious: your slides need logical organisation, logical flow. The presentation should be a holistic edifice; for example, the last slide should have some kind of relation to the first; some slides should complete what some others left hanging; and so on.

We cannot go in-depth here, but suffice it to say that if you pay attention to logic and flow, the structure will be strong. The audience must not be left wondering where you're "going with all this."

Tip

It's been said about popular science books: each equation cuts down sales or readership by a factor of two. In a similar way, each spelling or grammatical error could reduce interest in your presentation by a factor of.. shall we say four?

2.2 From Slide To Shining Slide

We just looked at what goes into the making of a good presentation. Let's now get to the topic of creating good slides, keeping those principles at the back of our minds.

A slide has several elements at various levels: design, layout, etc. at the top level; fonts, colours, etc. at the middle level; and so on. We'll now look at best practices for these. This is going to be a mixed bag. There will be dos and don'ts; there will be the good and the ugly; some things will be more important than others. We've therefore not categorised the following tips in any way. But they're all golden rules (or titanic rules, going by credit card nomenclature).

A slide or two per point

We said earlier that you should try and keep the number of key